JAZZ IN TADOMA

BY MATT "CERULEAN" CROSS THIEDE

PRE-BIRTH

HAIKU: THE BEAR AND THE OWL

BEAR:

The nature of love
Is wrapped up in the starshine—
Alive, warm inside

OWL:

Down deep in the Earth
So molten and sensual—
Kisses swirl soft sighs

ORDINATION

SEX AND GENDER

My Sister's Partner's shirt says, "My Pronouns Have Not Been Invented Yet"
I smoke a cigarette and think about the depth of the reality inside all of us
Language is ecstatic
Let's be mystics
Which means that we love complexity and magic in all of its forms

Gender has nothing to do with what's hidden in your pants
Gender is fluid
Sex has never been binary
Sex is a verb
Whether you have it or not

What do you call 3am?
Why do they teach us opposites?
Call me black as day
Call me shadow in light
Call me anything in between

Bodies come in infinite arrangements
Gender is fluid
Sex is a verb
For all intents and purposes

So open your heart—
Leave space in it
For everyone,
Including yourself

RECONCILIATION

WHEN JESUS MET OSIRIS

Jesus Was Disney on Steroids Thanks to His Time in America
Orisis Was up to His Ears in Divinatory Duties
No One Saw It Coming
But the Merfolk Wanted a Love Affair
So Delilah X Played a Conch for 23.73 Seconds
And Obatala Spun on his Head
While All the Fae Colonies Spread the Word
And the Mayans Reworked Reality in Preparation for the Meeting
Osiris Glowed Green As Promised
J Was Dressed in Fireflies
They Blinked Speechless Face to Face
And Traced Each Other's Lithe Bodies
As Their Eyelashes Birthed Galaxies
Causing the Nile to Flood and the Middle East to Erupt in Soft Loving Whispers
Cheikh Anta Diop Blessed the Union
Rumi Said A Few Words
The Spider Mother of the Infinite Cosmos Knit Them Matching Underwear
And E. Lynn Harris Signed the Book Agreement
The Honeymoon Was the Bee's Knees
First They Turned All the Guns Everywhere Into Flowers
Then That Night Jesus Walked Across the Full Bathtub and Gave O A Kiss
72 Beautiful Intersex Babies Were Born When Their Bodies Met
72,000 Robots Rose Up From the Sea to Engage Everyone in the Adjoining Vision
And All of the Animals, Plants, and People Rejoiced Between the Egyptian Cotton
Those Who Had Attended the Hand Fasting
Cried Tears of Joy Together For 35 Minutes at That Exact Moment
Curing the Multiverse of Cancer and HIV Forever
Dogs Everywhere Enjoyed Entire Walks in Public Off-Leash
Horseflies Talked To Horses and Started A Union
Frogs Stayed Frogs Even When Kissed By Desperate Princesses Who Were Forlorn
Everyone Over 100 Years Old Told Their Life Stories to 37 Children
And A Few Minnows Grew Into Adult Fish in 43 Seconds
The Days after the Honeymoon Were the Height of Excitement
J And O Came Home Together To Nablus
Where They Kissed Again, Blessing All People as Gods and Goddesses
Checkpoints Were a Thing Of The Past
All Borders Were Open
And They Set About Mapping All the Kingdoms of the New Earth
Based on the Long-Standing Blockchain Democracy
With Divine Thoughts and Intentions
So That All the Cars Were Electric
Even Though Bicycles Were More Interesting
And All Electricity Came From the Air through the Earth Just As Tesla Had Intended
The Next Day, They Started A Hip Hop Cypher
And Sketched Out a Graphic Novel
Based On All the Things They Would Do and Make Together
The First Chapter Was For a Global Currency Where Everyone Was Rich
And Could Trade For Everything They Needed
And The Rest . . . Was History

SLIPPERY WHEN WET

THINKING BACK

I never needed to know more than your love
Your particular way of loving
Holding me
Feeling your way into the way
I loved you

Tonight I'm mourning
The way you loved me
Whether I felt your true intentions
Or lost my way
Against the tapestry
Of our grief

As we danced in la calle
The rain falling
And the streetlamps
In your eyes
An aria of fresh linen
Against our naked bodies

Bliss (or whatever you called it)

Chingón
Będzie

That's we
You and me

JOURNEY (IN BED)

Your fingers
Painted gold with your braille nails
Tell stories untold
Touch my body
With such temoinant care

MY HEART

My heart is wet tobacco
A cigarette you can’t smoke
The garbage that makes you want to wash your hands
The trouble you can’t manage
The blood that drips from your hands
The splinter that your skin finally pushed out
That fell to the floor
Like so much dust
To be washed away by the tepid water of the river
Massaging the stones
Shaping the shore
Where I sit
Kissing you
Again
Breathing
Feeling
The course spots on your lips
The caress of your tongue
Your saliva
Yes, my heart
Is wet tobacco
A cigarette you can’t smoke
Your deepest dream
Of the moment
Everything changes

CATHARSIS

GRIEF

Grief is the rainbow
From which healing falls
An antidote to pain
Through your window

ART

I paint the stars
My eyes to sing
Of all the finer,
Finer things

LOVE

The purple rays
Of sunshine
Bless our tomorrows
As we shine in bliss

SO MANY TOMORROWS

Love, love, love is jazz in tadoma

ART BY JOAN G. STARK

```
                     \       /             _\/_
                       .-'-.               //o\  _\/_
  _  ___  __  _ --_ /     \ _--_ __  __ _ | __/o\\ _
=-=-_=-=-_=-=_=-_= -======- = =-=_=-=_,-'|"'""-|-,_
 =- _=-=-_=- _=-= _--=====- _=-=_-_,-"           |
jgs=- =- =-= =- = -  -===- -= - ."
```